



Department
for Work &
Pensions

Title, Forename, Surname
Address line 1
Address line 2
Address line 3
Address line 4
Postcode

DWP Funeral Payments
Mail Handling Site A
Wolverhampton
WV98 2AL

www.gov.uk

Telephone: 0800 151 2012
Textphone: 0800 731 0464

Your reference:
QQ123456C/001

About your claim for a Funeral Expenses Payment

Dear Jane Doe

We are sorry to hear about your bereavement.

On 1 April 2026 you made a claim for a Funeral Payment from the Social Fund.

For the funeral of Joe Bloggs

We have decided that you are entitled to a payment of £1,569.53.

This is for the following reason(s):

The following item(s) have been awarded in full:

Burial costs

The amount we can pay for the following expense(s) has been reduced. We have decided that the expense you have claimed is necessary, but the amount incurred is not reasonable; or is only partly necessary.

Burial plot

Because we reduced the amount allowed for the expenses listed above, we have paid an additional amount of (difference between amount claimed and amount awarded) towards the cost of other funeral expenses up to the maximum allowable.

The maximum we can pay for other funeral expenses is
£1,000.00.

However, the amount we are able to pay you has been reduced because you have told us that there is some money available:

**We have many different
ways we can
communicate with you.**

If you would like braille,
British Sign Language, a
hearing loop, translations,
large print, audio or
something else please
tell us using the phone
number at the top of this
letter.

Please turn over

- We have deducted the money available from any bank account from the maximum we could pay towards the funeral.

What to do

The way this has been calculated is shown on the page called

How we worked out the Funeral Payment

How you will receive your Direct Payment

Your bank details are known to us but have not been stated in this letter for security reasons. Any payment will be paid into this account. You can check the Funeral Payment on your account statement. Your statement will show the reference number shown at the top of this letter next to the payment from us.

You will receive this payment on 1 May 2026.

Payment to your Bank/Building Society

These notes are about payments into an account. Please make sure you read them.

You should check the account to see how much is paid in. If you think the payment is wrong, you should get in touch with us straight away. We will check your payment and tell you what will happen.

If the account goes overdrawn, the bank or building society may not let you take any money out of the account. Talk to the bank or building society if this happens. You should also tell us.

A funeral payment has to be repaid out of the estate if there is one. An estate is all the money, property and other things owned by the person who has died. But we do not count a home occupied by a widow or widower, or personal possessions left to relatives.

What to do

To help us decide if the funeral payment must be paid back, please fill in the reply sheet we have sent with this letter.

Send it back to us within 14 days of this letter. You can use the envelope we have sent you. If someone else is dealing with the estate, please tell us his or her name.

Please keep this letter, as you may need to refer to it again.

Yours sincerely,

Office manager

If you disagree with a decision

You can ask us to explain our decision

You, or someone who has the authority to act for you, can phone or write to us within one month of the date on this letter to ask us to explain our decision in writing.

You can also ask us to reconsider a decision

Tell us if you have more information, or if you think we have overlooked something which might change the decision. Do this within one month of the date on this letter.

We will look at what you tell us and send you a letter to tell you what we have decided, and why. We call this letter a Mandatory Reconsideration Notice.

When you have done this you can appeal

If you disagree with the Mandatory Reconsideration Notice, you can appeal to a tribunal.

You must wait for the Mandatory Reconsideration Notice before you start an appeal.

Treating people fairly

We are committed to the Equality Act 2010 and treating people fairly. To find out more about this law, search 'Equality Act' on www.gov.uk

Call charges

Calls to 0800 numbers are free from personal mobiles and landlines.

Why DWP needs personal information and how we treat it

We treat personal information carefully. We may use it for any of our purposes. To learn more about information rights and how we use information, please visit our DWP Personal Information Charter at www.gov.uk/dwp/personal-information-charter

How we worked out the Funeral Payment

The law tells us how to work out the Funeral Payment. For example, it tells us which items can be allowed in full and which can be paid up to a limit.

Item or items we can allow in full:

Burial costs	£650
The most we can allow for other funeral expenses	£1000.00

Item or items that have been reduced:

Burial plot	£400.00
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Money we take off the total we can allow.

The amount we can pay may be affected by other income, savings or other money you have. This is shown below:

Money available from bank accounts	£480.47
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The amount we will pay

Items allowed	£2,050.00
Money taken off	£480.47
Total amount	£1,569.53

We will pay £1,569.53